INBOUND · OUTBOUND · FIELD GUIDE

The Call *Script.*

A complete walk-through for Ethos, Final Expense, and Veterans intros — through underwriting, presentation, objections, and application.

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DOCUMENT	SECTIONS	USE
Sales Call Playbook	13 stages · 4 product variants	Internal training reference

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HOW TO READ THIS SCRIPT

(client's name) — replace with the prospect's first name.

(beneficiary) — the person they're protecting.

TONE / PACE — delivery cues for each section.

... — natural pause; let the silence work.

01 Intro — Ethos

TONE · CASUAL PACE · SLOWEST

Hey client's name?... client's name, this is just your name getting back to you. It looks like a little while back you were checking some rates through Ethos for insurance — the reason I'm calling is everyone was getting really high rates shown. Did you get shown an expensive quote, or what happened with that?

Ok, makes sense why this came to me. On the site it only shops one company, so the prices are usually higher than normal. I'm licensed directly with the state of state, so my job is to help you shop all of the companies and find the actual best rate and make sure you're not overpaying for your coverage.

I don't want to get ahead of myself though — what had you on there in the first place? Do you not currently have any coverage, or were you just trying to see if there were any better options out there?

02 Intro — Final Expense

TONE · CASUAL PACE · SLOWEST

Hey client's first name?... client's first name, this is just your first name. I had a second to get back to you here. Looks like you asked us to give you a call... seems you were possibly looking at some options for final expense and burial coverage. What ended up happening with that — did you get something in place, or are you still on the hunt for options?

03 Intro — Veterans

TONE · CASUAL PACE · SLOWEST

Hey client's first name?... client's first name, this is just your first name giving you a call from the veterans benefits office. Looks like you asked us to give you a call here — seems you were possibly looking at some final expense and burial coverage options for veterans. You listed your branch of service as branch, is that correct?

Okay, I'm just the state-licensed underwriter assigned to your file here. Were you just looking for coverage options on yourself, or you and a loved one?

04 The Why

TONE · CURIOUS PACE · SLOW

DIG INTO THE WHY. YOU WILL RECAP IT BEFORE NUMBERS — BUT YOU NEED TO UNDERSTAND WHY THEY ARE LOOKING FOR COVERAGE.

THESE QUESTIONS ARE NOT MEANT TO BE READ WORD-FOR-WORD, LINE BY LINE. THEY'RE EXAMPLES TO HELP UNCOVER THE WHY — LET THE CONVERSATION FLOW NATURALLY INSTEAD OF RUNNING DOWN A CHECKLIST.

01 Ok got it... and just so I'm on the same page... are you mainly concerned about covering funeral expenses, taking care of a mortgage, or what's the goal?

02 Why is that something that you want to make sure is covered?

03 What made you want to look into options now — did anything happen recently?

04 Who would be the person picking up the pieces if something happened to you or your income?

05 Do you have anything in place for beneficiary right now?

06 What would things look like for them financially if that happened and there was no coverage in place to help?

07 How long have you been looking around for?

08 What's the reason you haven't been able to get anything in place so far — prices too high, trouble getting approved, or just hasn't been a priority until recently?

RECAP LINE

Got it... so basically you're looking for some coverage to take care of beneficiary so that the goal isn't a burden on them when you pass away... did I miss anything?

05 Structure

TONE · UPBEAT & CONFIDENT · PACE · SLOW

Well in case you missed it, my name is **your name**. My job is super easy. I'm licensed with the state of **state** and work with all of the insurance companies in **state**. I just grab some details from you to shop for you to see who would offer you the lowest rate.

Once we find the lowest rate, you custom-design your own plan and price exactly how you want — and then we just submit an application to see if we can get an offer back from the carrier. Make sense?

CREDENTIALS HAND-OFF

Before we get started, the state requires I provide you with my credentials. Go ahead and grab something to write with and let me know when you're ready so I can give that to you.

> *My name is **spell out name**, and my license number is **NPN**. Do you have that? Go ahead and read that back to me just to make sure you have it correctly.*

The reason I give you that is once we find the best plan for you, the application requires sensitive info like your address, social, bank info. So legally I have to provide my details, so you know I'm licensed with the state and have my background checks done and all that.

06 Suitability

TONE · DOCTOR / PATIENT · PACE · MEDIUM

Okay, client's name, keep in mind — none of these questions are going to determine if you get approved or not. The insurance companies look at the medical records to determine that. These questions are just going to help me figure out which carriers are the best fit so I can actually give you accurate numbers. I don't handle any of the sales or approvals; I just work on your behalf to help you find the best rate in your state. Make sense?

IDENTITY & BENEFICIARY

Just to confirm: I have you listed as age years young, correct? And then confirming the beneficiary is beneficiary — and then what is their DOB?

LIFESTYLE

And then do you smoke, chew, vape, or anything like that? And you don't have like a part-time gig for Red Bull where you jump out of planes for a living, or backflip motorcycles over a canyon, or a stunt pilot? Ok just checking — and any felonies or DUIs?

HOUSING & OUTFLOWS

Ok now, are you still chipping away at the house, or are you renting? Ok, what's that ballpark payment every month? Any idea how much is left on the mortgage? And then what about car payments? Any other properties or six-figure debts or anything? And then utilities around 200–300 a month? And then another few hundred for food or fun? Anything else outbound that I'm missing? Ok so about $ amount going out for expenses every month.

INCOME

And then what is your ballpark monthly or annual income? Ok so we have about $ in coming in and roughly $ out going out — does that sound pretty close? Not missing anything major? Now, is that work income, social security, retirement — or how is that set up?

IF INCOME SOURCE IS…

- **Work** — Ok so the paycheck gone for life is kinda why we're looking for some financial relief and security for beneficiary, since that would be a pretty big difference month to month, especially over time. That sounds about right?
- **Retirement** — With Social Security, I'm sure they explained to you that you get to keep the larger of the two socials in the household? Ok good. And then with the retirement, is it set to have 40–50% survivorship, or is it zero? I ask because almost nobody has 100% survivorship, and that income adjustment is what can be pretty rough long term for the survivor.

MEDICAL HISTORY

In your lifetime, any major illnesses such as cancer, heart attacks, strokes, brain aneurism, COPD, any organ issues? Major arthritis, MS — anything you've ever been diagnosed with or treated for? *(If yes: what? when? any complications?)*

And then in the last 10 years — any major surgeries or medical procedures? And then any and all prescriptions in the last decade — whether you filled them, took them, don't take anymore, or are currently on them. Just any and all you can remember from the last 10 years. And what are you taking those for currently? *(If yes: what? when? any complications?)*

And would you say that everything is well controlled — any complications? Alright, then what's a ballpark of your height and weight? Ok, any other meds or health stuff that you can think of?

07 Underwriting Cheatsheet

REFERENCE

ANY OF THE FOLLOWING → GO WHOLE LIFE.

WHOLE LIFE TRIGGERS

any one is enough

4 or More Meds	70+ Years Old	Afib	Alzheimer's GIWL
Amputations	Bipolar / Schizo	Cancer	COPD
Drug / Alcohol Abuse	Felony in 10 Yrs	Heart Attack	Heart Disease / Failure
Insulin	Kidney Disease / Failure	Liver Disease / Failure	Neuropathy
Obesity	Oxygen GIWL	Stroke	Stents

GIWL = Guaranteed Issue Whole Life. Default to GIWL where flagged regardless of other factors.

08 Presentation

TONE · TEACHER · PACE · SLOW

Now client, just so you know — all of the plans we'll be looking at today are provided by carriers that are **A-Rated**... and they've all been around for over 100 years. Go ahead and write down these benefits.

WHOLE LIFE	IUL	TERM
PERMANENT	**PERMANENT**	**DAY 1 COVERAGE**
The policy will never expire. If you live to 113 years old it will still be there to pay out.	The policy will never expire. If you live to 113 years old it will still be there to pay out.	Effective upon approval. No 2-year wait — approved today, hit by a bus tomorrow → pays the full benefit, no questions asked.
DAY 1 COVERAGE	**DAY 1 COVERAGE**	**TAX-FREE DEATH BENEFIT**
Effective upon approval. No 2-year wait like those ones they advertise on TV — approved today, hit by a bus tomorrow → pays the full benefit, no questions asked.	Effective upon approval. No 2-year wait — approved today, hit by a bus tomorrow → pays the full benefit, no questions asked.	Covers any cause of death. Pays your beneficiary 100% tax-free — no probate, no check to Uncle Sam.
LIVING BENEFITS	**LIVING BENEFITS**	**MAJOR ILLNESS**
Pays out at death — and also pays if you become terminally ill with less than 12 months to live. Hopefully you never have to use that part.	Pays out at death — and also pays if you become sick or disabled. Hopefully you never have to use that part.	Pays out at death — and pays up to 75% if you become sick with a major illness like cancer or heart attack.
FIXED PREMIUM	**FIXED PREMIUM**	**DISABILITY**
Locked in for life. Will never increase in price — no surprise bills, ever.	Locked in for life. Never increases in price.	You're also taken care of if you become disabled and can't work or perform daily activities like walking, driving, feeding, or bathing.

END OF PRESENTATION

09 Recap the Why

TONE · CONCERNED & CURIOUS · PACE · SLOW

THESE QUESTIONS ARE NOT NECESSARILY MEANT TO BE READ WORD-FOR-WORD. USE THIS AS A GUIDE TO HELP DIG INTO THE WHY AND BUILD EMOTION — INSPIRATION, NOT A SCRIPT TO RECITE LINE BY LINE.

It'll take a few minutes for this to all load up. While we're waiting for that, I was curious — why is it important for you to actually get at least something in place for beneficiary? Is it kind of just like, whenever you get around to it — or is it actually something that's pretty important and a priority to you?

Is it more that beneficiary could come up with the money on their own and cover things, and you just don't want to have to do that? Or is it more that if they had to come up with the money, it would put them in a bad spot financially?

Ahh, I see. I guess — how would you feel about them having to do that if something happened with no coverage?

Yeah I get what you mean. I've seen that happen a lot. *(personal story)*

Well it's great that you're being proactive about all this. Unfortunately, most people leave this on the back burner until it's too late. beneficiary is lucky to have someone like you that cares about them the way you do.

> *Even though most of us don't like to think about it, the bottom line is we are all going to die at some point. We hope it doesn't happen for a long time – but you know the saying, prepare for the worst and hope for the best.*

(let them respond)

It's crazy though — I talk to a lot of people, and some people just think of it like it's not their problem since they won't be around anymore. You know what I mean? Makes sense. I can tell this is important to you.

01 How much easier do you think things would be for beneficiary if they received a check to cover everything and didn't have to worry about the money at all... while they were grieving?

02 How do you think it would affect beneficiary having to take on the weight of planning and paying for everything while trying to grieve?

Okay, this all makes sense. It sounds like you're the kind of person that's smart enough to know you need to be proactive and how important this is. And it seems like you looked at it before, but it just wasn't good timing or in the budget. But you know you should do something — because if something happened now, it doesn't sound like things would be very easy for beneficiary.

Well, let's go over the best option so they don't have to do that.

10 Pre-Frame & Numbers

TONE · ASSUMPTIVE → NEUTRAL · PACE · MEDIUM → SLOW

PRE-FRAME

So the way this works is that my system shops through ALL the A-Rated carriers for us — Mutual of Omaha, Aflac, Aetna, etc. — so you don't have to waste time calling 52 different carriers just to get the best rate. Make sense?

I'm assuming you're like most of our clients — you just want me to pull up the plan that comes back with the lowest rate? Or did you have a company in mind you are loyal to even if it means paying twice as much?

Ok, the system is going to provide 3 initial recommendations. Then after we look at those 3 initial recommendations, we'll adjust the coverage up or down until we find the sweet spot that's comfortable for you. Sound good?

THREE RECOMMENDATIONS

1 — BARE MINIMUM · COVER THE BASES

It'll pay out $ ___ thousand to beneficiary to cover the goal. Now that plan comes in at just $ ___ bucks.

2 — A LITTLE EXTRA SUPPORT

If you felt like beneficiary needed more support after you're gone, the 2nd recommendation will cover the goal plus a little extra — that's $ ___ thousand of coverage, and it's only $ ___ bucks.

3 — A LOT EXTRA · MAXIMUM COMFORT

If you felt like beneficiary needed more support after you're gone, the 3rd recommendation will cover the goal plus a lot extra — that's $ ___ thousand of coverage, and it's only $ ___ bucks.

Now we can customize this of course — but based on those 3 options, which one do you feel fits the budget and makes the most sense?

11 Objections & Closing

TONE · ASSUMPTIVE | PACE · MEDIUM

OBJECTION 01 *"Need to think about it."*

> Of course. Now one option as well that most people don't know about is — since the carrier has to come back with an offer first — they do allow us to send it in for whatever your bare minimum is, to cover your bases and give you peace of mind. Then anytime down the road you can always call in to increase. So does that bottom option make sense as a good starting point to cover your bases, or do we need to adjust?

OBJECTION 02 *"Need to talk to someone."*

> Not a problem at all. Now, when you chat with them — do you think **beneficiary** would be opposed to having an extra **$ ___ thousand** to help with things after you're gone?
>
> ANY RESPONSE →
> I'm guessing like most people, they won't be upset about having some extra money to help with things after you're gone — but they would definitely be upset if there was absolutely zero left behind. So why don't we just do this: let's just start at that lower option, then you can run it by them over the coming weeks. And if they get mad at you for not getting *enough* coverage, you can give me a call and we'll bump it up. Sound good?

OBJECTION 03 *"Can you email me all this?"*

> Yeah of course. Once you're approved, the carrier will email AND mail you the policy packet with all the black-and-white details. Right now we just got to figure out which one makes sense as a good starting point to cover your bases. Do you feel like that bottom option is comfortable every month, or do we need to adjust?

OBJECTION 04 *"That's too expensive."*

> I understand. In a perfect world we all want to leave our family with a million dollars and pay like $20/month — but like I mentioned earlier, insurance is all regulated based on your age and health. So your rates at **age** years old are going to be quite a bit different than a 22-year-old. But at the end of the day, you had mentioned that **beneficiary** would be in a tough spot when you pass away, correct?
>
> Let's just send it in for that bottom option. That at least gives you peace of mind if something happens sooner rather than later — at least they'll have *some* help instead of none. Sound good?

OBJECTION 05 *"I'll just save the money instead."*

> Of course you should keep saving money — but what most people do is they split their risk. So that if, God forbid, something unexpected happens next month or next year, the insurance policy will pay out way more than you would have saved on your own. Does that make sense?
>
> So why don't we do this — to mitigate your risk, let's just start with that lower option so that even if you make 1 premium payment, then something happens, the insurance company will pay the full benefit no questions asked. Sound good?

12 Application — Identity & Medical

TONE · DOCTOR / PATIENT · PACE · MEDIUM

TRANSITION

Ok, sounds good. I'll go ahead and pull up the application portal on my end. The first thing they ask for is your driver's license number to verify your identity. Go ahead and grab that real quick while I wait for this to load.

MEDICAL RECORD CHECK

Alright — and then for the medical record check, what's your social?

SSN PUSHBACK *"I don't want to give you my social."*

> I totally understand. Without your social, the carrier has *no way* to validate your medical history. Without it, you can't get insurance *anywhere* — so you can just go ahead with that when you're ready. *(Important: say with extreme confidence, then say nothing and wait.)*

"NO" #2 →

I totally understand. You DID get my card with my license number — will you pull up your texts real quick so we can take a look at that? That 8-digit number right below my name is my National Producer Number. That's the license number they gave me after I went through all the federal background checks and fingerprinting. So everything is secure — you can just go ahead with that.

"NO" #3 →

I understand the hesitation. Let's do this — we can hop on a quick FaceTime or Zoom so you can see I'm just a boring insurance guy, not some crazy person, and I'll show you my ID. This is your cellphone, right? I'll text you the link.

13 Application — Banking

TONE · DOCTOR / PATIENT · PACE · MEDIUM

Of course, like I mentioned, they won't draft until after approval. What bank do you use?

Ok, I have their routing number as routing # . *(Google the bank and city and routing number — read it back. Right 99% of the time.)* And the account number?

BANKING PUSHBACK A *"Don't have that info."*

> Not a problem. Go ahead and grab a check or bank statement — it'll have it on there.

"NO / CAN'T" →
Ok, just go ahead and pull up your mobile banking app.

"NO / CAN'T" #2 →
Got it. Let's just call the bank directly. Who do you bank with?

BANKING PUSHBACK B *"Don't want to give banking over phone."*

> I totally understand. This is just like when you got your car insurance — again, they won't draft until after approval, but the carrier requires it on the application. Without it, you can't get insurance anywhere. Does that make sense?

"YES" →
Ok I can pull up your routing number in our system. Who do you bank with? And was that set up in the state of state ? Ok, let me know when you're ready to confirm the routing number — I'll read off what our system shows.

"NO" #1 →
You DID get my card with my license number — pull up your texts real quick. That 8-digit number right below my name is my National Producer Number, given to me after federal background checks and fingerprinting. If you'd like, we can call the department of insurance to validate my license. Would that help?

"NO" #2 →
I understand the hesitation. Would it help you if we jumped on a FaceTime or Zoom so you can see I'm just a boring insurance agent and a real person?

BANKING PUSHBACK C *"I can't have it charge me yet."*

> Not a problem. As I mentioned, nothing will be charged today because you haven't been approved yet. It'll take them at least a couple days to approve you, and then after that they'll draft that initial premium so that you're covered immediately. So if something unexpected happens, it'll pay the full benefit the next day. Make sense?

"NO" #1 →
The default here is that the carrier drafts a couple days after approval since it's immediate coverage like you wanted. Then if we need to adjust the recurring date, just give me a call and we can change that. Sound good?

"NO" #2 →
Ohhh — so if they try to draft in the next few days, there won't be anything in there? Are you like most people, you get paid every Friday? Ok, well, it's some extra paperwork on my end, but if it helps you, I'm happy to push it out a week. Would that help you?

14 Final Recap & Wrap Up

TONE · CASUAL | PACE · MEDIUM

FINAL RECAP (BEFORE SUBMIT)

CONFIRM BEFORE SUBMITTING

Just before I proceed forward to the last page... let me just recap so we're on the same page. So today we're just sending it in for the $ ___ thousand of coverage, and the premium will be $ ___ bucks a month, and your beneficiary is beneficiary — is that all correct?

Ok, from here, when I submit this today, it's going to take them about 1 to 2 days to approve you. Once approved in the next couple days, they'll draft that initial premium to cover you immediately — so if, God forbid, you get struck by lightning the next day, it'll pay that full benefit for you. Alright?

LAST AUTHORIZATION & WRAP UP

Once they activate the insurance in the next couple days, you'll get the policy packet in the mail in about 2–3 weeks. When you get that, there's nothing you need to do — that's just for your records, so put it in a safe spot. And then of course I come with the policy, so if you ever need anything just give me a call. Ok?

Alright, I got that all submitted for you. Now once we jump off the phone, I'd like you to save my number in your contacts. This is my direct contact, so I'd like you to save it in your phone. Ok?

In a couple minutes, my portal will provide me with your application number — which will be the same as the policy number — so I'll text that over to you as well.

Do you have any questions for me before I let you go?

> *It was a pleasure helping you out today. Have a great rest of your day.*

End of script · 13 of 13